Twitter and Tea

Getting Engaged in Bank Street's Social Media Strategy

February 2018

Where We Are Now

- Over 30 Bank Street-associated social media accounts with varying degrees of activity
- Faculty, staff, students, and families are hungry for a stronger and more consistent Bank Street social media presence and institutional support
- Synchronizing some of our storytelling efforts will help Bank Street break though on social media to more firmly assert our expertise and voice

Where We Are Heading

- We are building a sustainable social media strategy that leverages "socially engaged" faculty and staff to help push out a deeper and broader understanding of Bank Street's work to amplify our impact and reach in the world

- We aim to connect with:
  - External audiences: press, thought leaders/key influencers, potential donors, prospective students/families, and alumni
  - Internal audiences: faculty, staff, and current students/families

- Our immediate focus: Twitter—one of the most impactful social platforms for sharing academic news and promoting social change!
  - Snapshot of Success:
    Hechinger's story on the Family Center
    - Impressions: 1,584 (number of times users saw this tweet)
    - Engagement: 29 (number of times a user interacted with this tweet)
    - Engagement rate: 1.8% (.33%-1% is industry standard for a high engagement rate)

Social Media Strategy Overview

Goals

- Drive awareness of Bank Street programs and work
- Position Bank Street as a leading voice in progressive education
- Connect with social thought leaders to amplify our impact and reach

Strategic Approach

- Identify key content themes tied to our work and mission and generate more content for main Bank Street accounts—namely @BankStreetEdu on Twitter
- Engaging with key faculty and staff across Bank Street to collaborate on amplifying this content as well as expanding our reach through content development
- Develop supports and processes for faculty and staff engagement

Key Content Themes

- Bank Street understands the link between emotional and cognitive learning for adults and children (#SEL)
- Bank Street believes that an investment in early care and education can help close the achievement gap in the U.S. (#earlyed; #ECE)
- Bank Street recognizes that the way teachers learn to teach impacts the way children learn and that aspiring teachers need opportunities to connect theory to practice (#teacherprep; #SustainableFundingProject)
- Bank Street understands that we cannot address issues of equity in our country without paying attention to questions around race, racism, and access to high-quality teacher preparation and educational opportunities (#edequity)
- Bank Street knows that progressive education is a rigorous, carefully planned approach to learning that leads to deep engagement by students and helps produce democratic citizens (#progressiveeducation)
- Bank Street believes strong schools align instruction, culture, and structure to support student and adult learning and that the best districts focus on supporting this instructional work in schools rather than disrupting it (#BankStreetEdCenter)
- Bank Street understands the importance of empowering teachers and building reflective and collaborative teacher teams to support strong schools and student learning (#BankStreetEdCenter; #teacherteams)
- Bank Street is dedicated to empowering school leaders to build strong, progressive schools and school systems (#schoolleaders; #progressiveeducation)
- Bank Street knows that joyful play and academic learning in early education are not mutually exclusive—math language and concepts can be integrated into a play-based curriculum (#earlyed; #ECE)

Example

Bank Street understands the link between emotional and cognitive learning for adults and children

Bank Street College @bankstreetedu · 18 Dec 2017

"It's so important for all school staff to be aware that emotional wellbeing is foundational to learning" – #BankStreet's Lesley Koplow at this year's Safe and Sound Schools Conference. Read more about this year's event bit.ly/2CBmKOF

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Bank Street College @bankstreetedu · 18 Dec 2017

#BankStreet's @SolorzaCristian challenges us to rethink dual language education in a thoughtful new article that discusses how encouraging #bilingualism in the classroom makes learning more meaningful bit.ly/2CV7Rrr

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Bank Street College @bankstreetedu · 9 Dec 2017

A @BankStreetAlum in action! #ChildLife #bankstreet #bankstreetedu

Shani Thornton @Childlifemommy

From #ChildLife patient to Child Life specialist So proud of our @bankstreetedu student, Camille! | VUMC Voice voice.vumc.org/child-life-pat ...

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Example

Bank Street believes that an investment in early care and education can help close the achievement gap in the U.S.

Bank Street College Retweeted

Shael Suransky @Shaelsuransky · 18 Dec 2017

Had a terrific visit w/ #Guttman cohort of 0-3 #earlychildhood educators in East New York - the work they're doing is a potent way to ensure healthy development & reduce achievement gaps. See related @Chalkbeat story: chalkbeat.org/posts/ny/2017/...

Bank Street College @bankstreetedu · 11 Dec 2017

Check out the new Learning Agenda blog post about @BankStHeadStart's fall curriculum complete with nature walks, pumpkin carving and collage-making!

Bank Street Head Start Shares Fall Curriculum

Leaves are falling from the trees, temperatures are dropping, and the fall season is coming to an end. As we get ready to welcome winter, we'd like...

bankstreet-ipr-blog.com

Bank Street College Retweeted

Shael Suransky @Shaelsuransky · 15 Dec 2017

From any perspective - academic, socio-emotional, financial, equity - pre-k is a force for good #earlychildhood

Does Preschool Pay Off? Tulsa Says Yes

Tulsa, Okla., has been the focus of much debate over the long-term benefits of preschool. The most recent findings by Georgetown University...

npr.org

GSE Admissions

PLACEHOLDER FOR:

Graduate School Admissions Social Media Strategy

Ways to Get Involved on Twitter

1. Follow and retweet posts from Bank Street accounts, including: @BankStreetEdu, @BankStreetLib, @BankStreetAlum, @ShaelSuransky, @SFC_BankStreet

2. Subscribe to the internal and external "lists" created by @BankStreetEdu to follow key influencers and active Twitter users inside and outside of the institution

3. Use #BankStreet for posts related to your work or tag—this helps to organize tweets about Bank Street together and promotes engagement

4. Tag @BankStreetEdu or @ShaelSuransky (or other accounts) to notify these users of your tweet—this makes it more likely that your tweet will be seen and shared

5. Use secondary hashtags to support your key message and promote engagement (see key messages), for example: #progressiveeducation, #early ed, #teacherteams. #teacherprep, #edequity

6. Use secondary hashtags for specific events or initiatives, for example: #NiemeyerTalks, #WeAreBankStreet (Giving Day), #BankStreetEdCenter, #BiberConvocation

Ways to Share Content

If you have content for @BankStreetEdu, email Pamela (pguarrera@bankstreet.edu):

- Brief summary of information
- Link to more information (if possible)
- Photo (if possible)

**NOTE: Is Pamela the right contact here? Do we want to set up another process?

Types of Content

1. Event announcements or events that you're planning on attending
2. Program-related news and events
3. Press mentions and community news stories (i.e., stories relevant to your work)
4. Snapshots of practice
5. Faculty and staff publications and/or appearances
6. Current work from your current or former students (if relevant)